Version
22/08-1

SIMMARKET VENDOR PORTAL MANUAL

Internal use only

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FOREWORD

Dear Vendor, the SIMMARKET Team welcomes you and thanks you for joining our platform to sell your products for flight simulators. We are one of the leading places in the Flight Simulation Add-on business and we will be happy to work with you to achieve successful sales for your products.

For you this Vendor Portal will become the main instrument of your work on SIMMARKET. The easy and feature-rich tool will help you manage your product portfolio, control pricing, sales and customer support.

This manual is designed to help you submit your first product or/and to edit an existing one and how to manage your accounting data so you can begin to sell quickly. It can be used as reference and will be updated accordingly.

Sincerely,

The SIMMARKET Team

FIRST THINGS FIRST: LOGIN TO VENDOR PORTAL

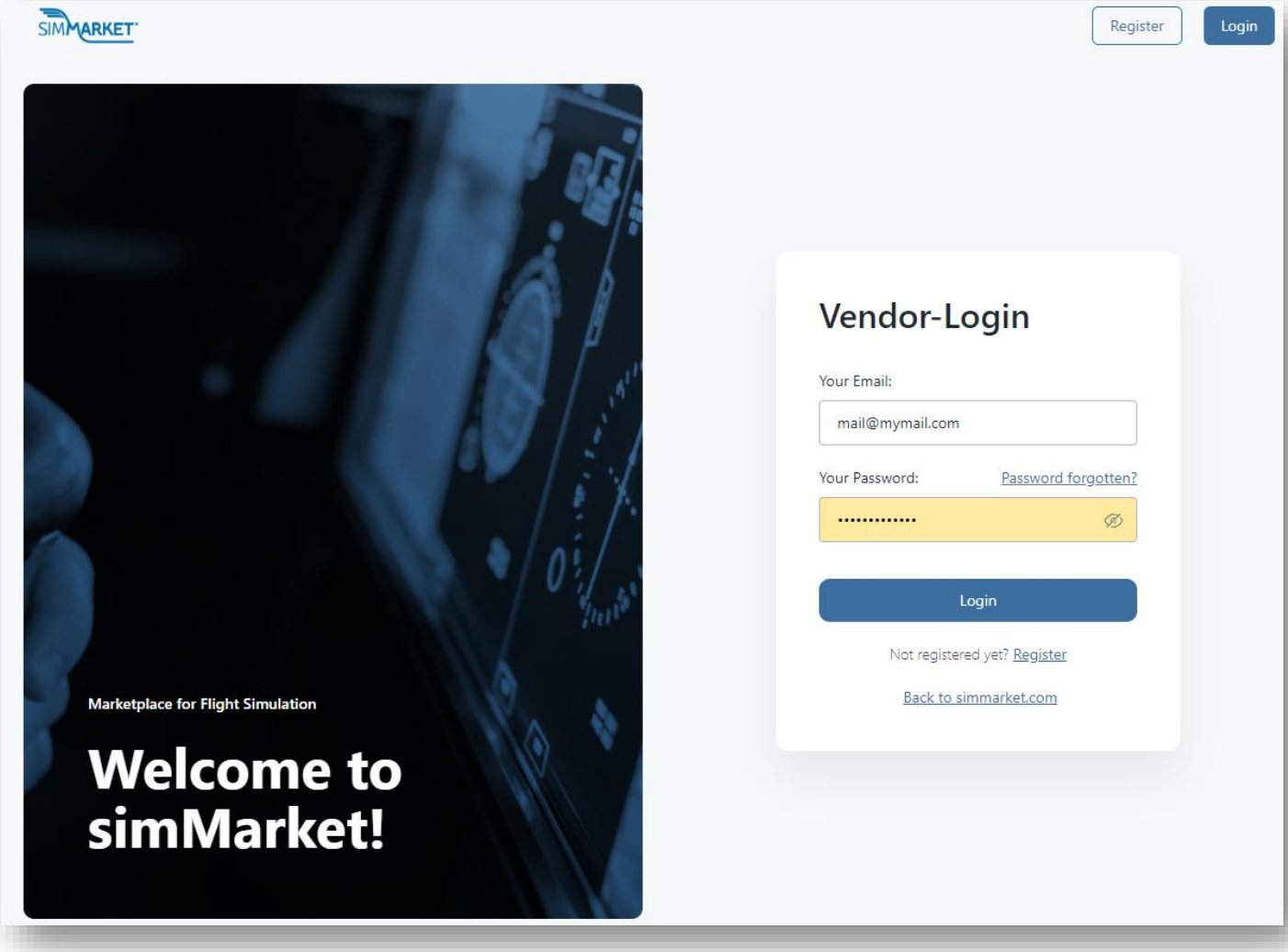
We are sure, if you are reading this document, you have already completed your registration and familiarized with our commission plans. If for some reason you don't check this page to know what we offer for our partners.

To login Vendor Portal follow the link: https://vendor.SIMMARKET.com/login.php. It's a good idea to save it in "Favorites" in your browser or you can always use the menu on SIMMARKET front-page.

To enter your Vendor Portal use your email and password you set during the registration procedure. All your personal details are protected but we recommend using only strong passwords to keep your account safe.

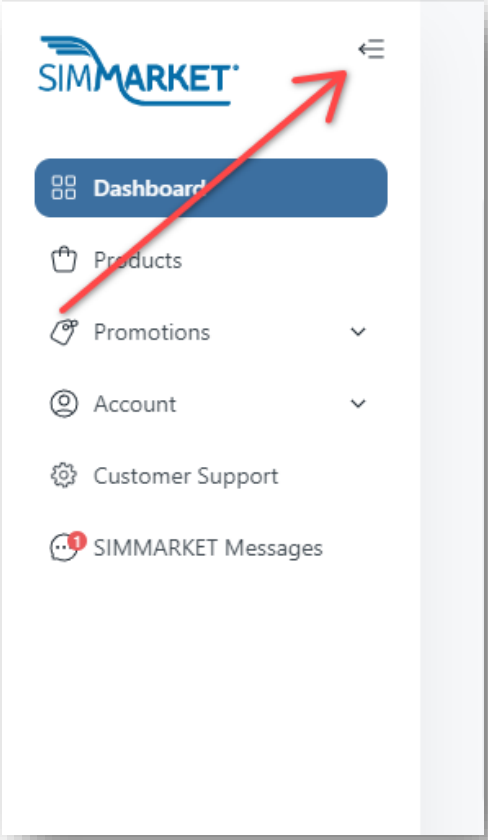
If you forgot your password use *Password forgotten?* link and we will restore your access to Vendor Portal.

After you enter your credentials press the **LOGIN** button and let's overview the interface.



Vendor Portal structure

Our Vendor Portal was designed to help our partners reach maximum productivity with a modern interface, flexible and easy to use functions. With us you can concentrate all your power on “creative work” instead of “paper work”.



The Vendor Portal structure is:

- Dashboard;
- Products;
- Promotions;
- Account;
- Customer Support;
- SIMMARKET Messages

Now let’s talk about how to use all Vendor Portal features in detail.

FYI: You can hide the sidebar by pressing ≡ button next to SIMMARKET logo.

Dashboard

Page overview

DASHBOARD is your "Homepage" in the Vendor Portal. You can use this page to see the most important and vital information about your business.

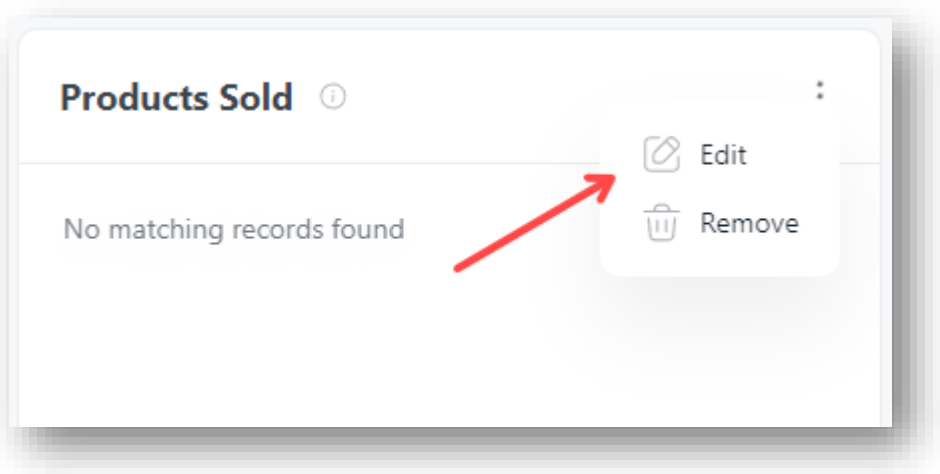
Page and widgets customization

This page can be customized to your own needs with a small element calling **WIDGETS**. To add or remove widgets use the **+ Add Widget** button. Our widgets library can fulfill most needs of your business. Press on the button and tick the widgets you need and they will appear on the page.

You can not only add widgets but also you can move them with "Drag-n-Drop" and arrange widgets as you like.

To move a widget, click the Left Mouse Button on ⋮ symbol on the right corner and keep LMB pressed and move it to the new location. Once you select a place for a widget just release the LMB.

You also can set a custom name for widget title. To do this press ⋮ LMB and select **EDIT** from the menu.



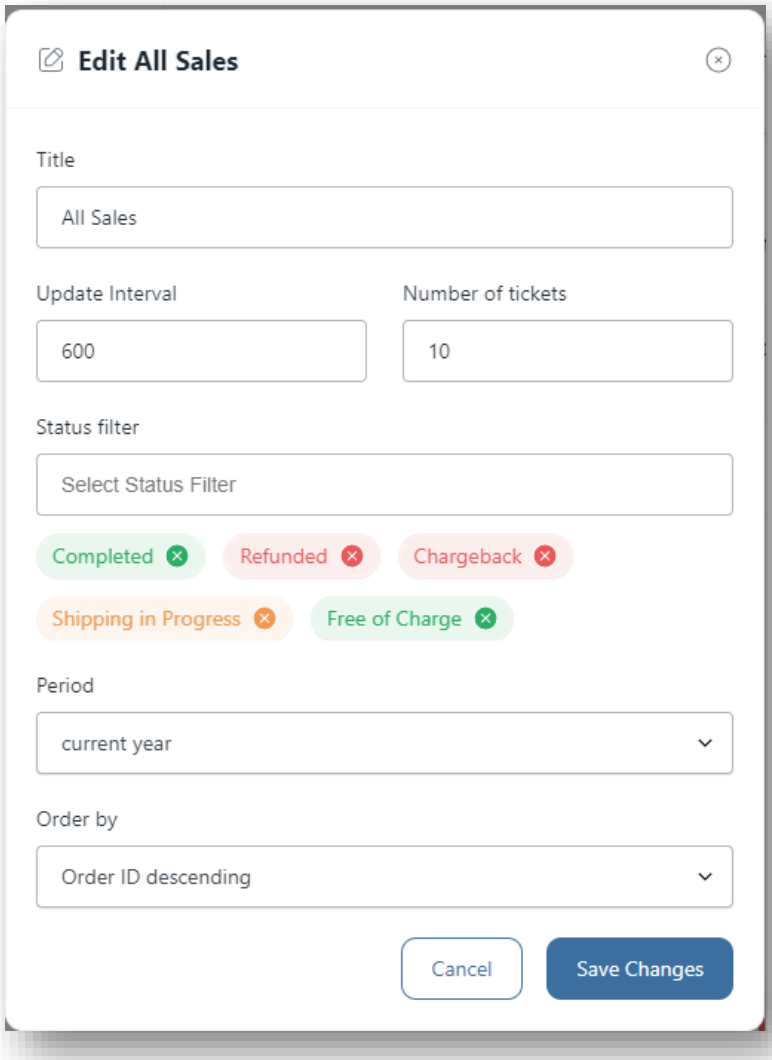
A new window will open. Use the text field under the **TITLE** to enter a new widget title. To update press the **Save Changes** button.

In some cases, widgets can be customized not only with title but with information on it too. For example, the widget **All Sales** can not only show selected ticket statuses, you can also set the update interval, how many tickets to show, a set time period and the displaying order.

Some widgets also have shortcuts to actions, like **Promotions Overview**. You can start a new promotion directly from the widget heading by clicking on the New **PROMOTION** button.

TL;DR: To customize a widget use ⚙ and set parameters to your own personal taste.

We recommend you to use only widgets that are really important for your and your business model to help you keep an eye only on the most important information, all the rest information like reports are available in their own sections.



Now, if your **DASHBOARD** is ready, let's jump to the **PRODUCTS** menu to learn how to add, edit and control your products.

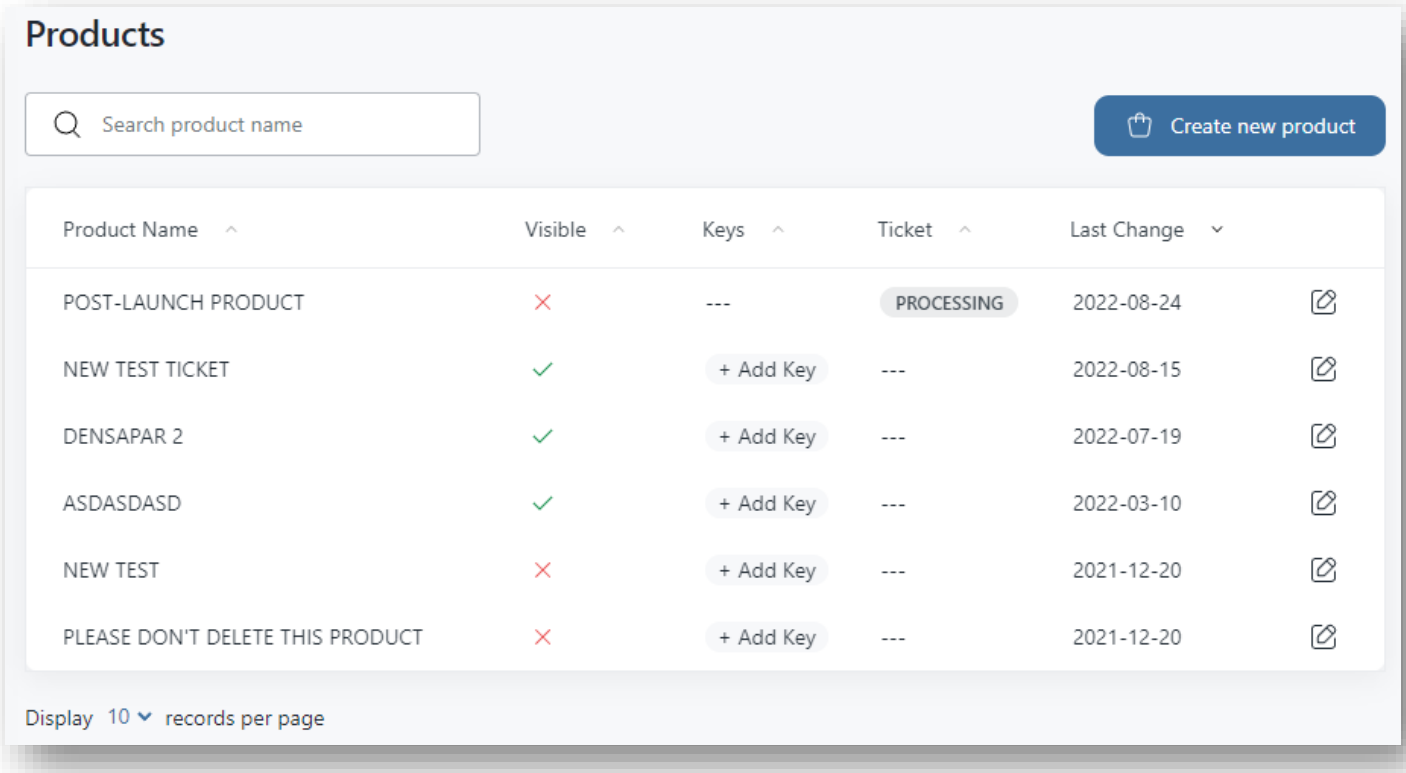
PRODUCTS

PAGE OVERVIEW

Maybe the most important part of the Vendor Portal, from here you can submit new products, upload updates and edit your portfolio.

The page can be customized: you can set how many products to show per page. You can show from 10 to 60 records per page or show all your products at once.

Full-text “Live” search is also available to make your work easier. To start searching, start typing and the system immediately will show search results meeting your criteria. To clear a search just erase all symbols in the search field.



Let’s create your first product!

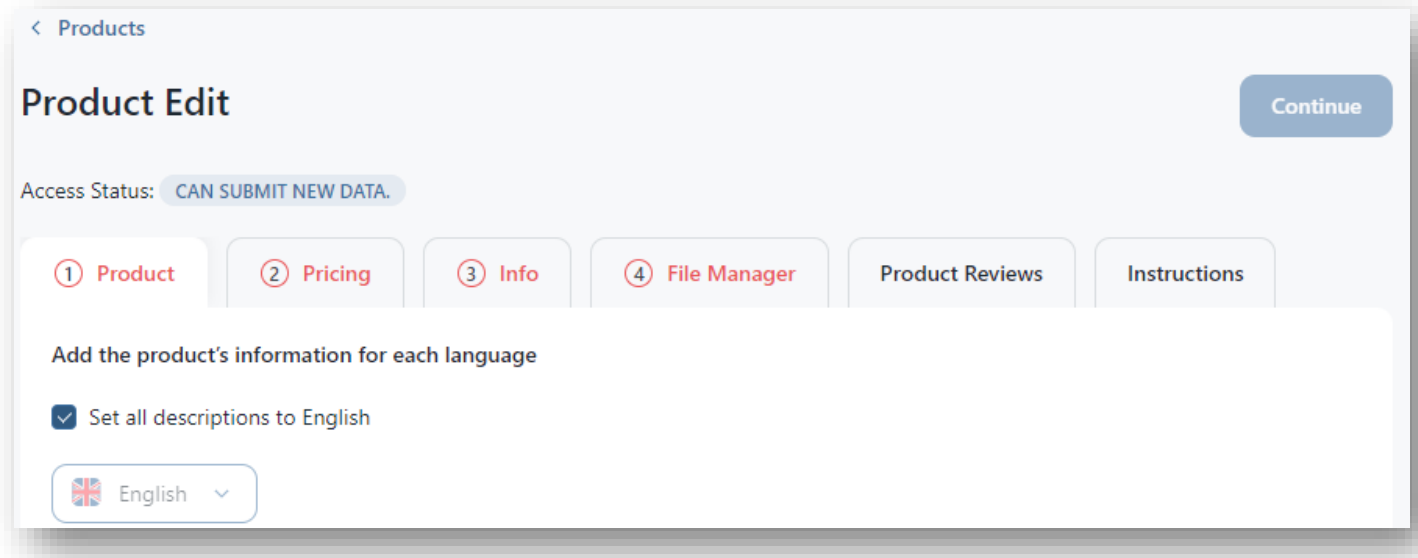
CREATING NEW PRODUCT

To create a new product, click the LeftMouseButton on **CREATE NEW PRODUCT** button and the product creation/editing wizard will open.

Check your **Access Status** on top and if you can see the wording **CAN SUBMIT NEW DATA,** then go ahead, if not contact our support team for details.

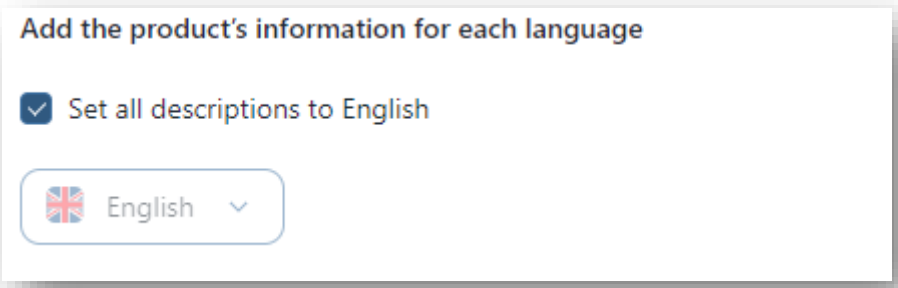
The product submitting wizard is a step-by-step procedure to make the whole process easier and exclude mistakes.

Steps from 1 to 4 are mandatory, fields with * are required fields. **Product Reviews** and **Instructions** are optional.



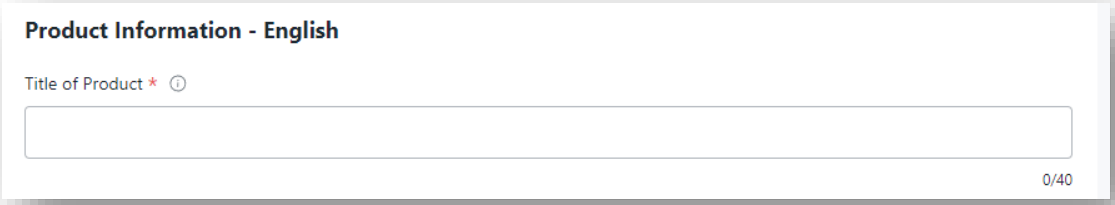
STEP 1: PRODUCT

Description languages



First of all, depending on your preference you can decide if you want to set all descriptions in English or you want to add multi-language description. If you tick **Set all descriptions to English** then all your text will be in English, no matter what language selected by the customer in the SIMMARKET shop or app. If not, then you will be able to add texts also in German, French, Chinese and Russian. Country flags will help you determine what language version you are on now.

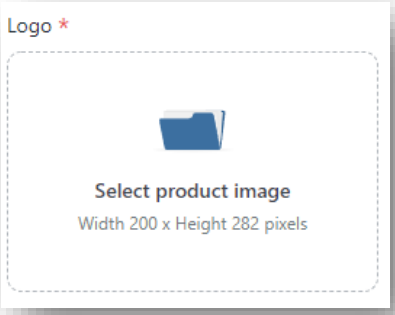
Title of Product



Use the text field to enter your product name. Here you don't need to enter your vendor name, only the product name with a maximum of 40 characters and it is very important to include the compatible simulator here (e.g MSFS, XP11, P3D).

The title is very important for sales and before submitting it you should make sure that it gives reliable and precise information about your product (for example IATA CODE, aircraft abbreviation and compatible SIMULATOR) as it will be used for all search engines including Google.

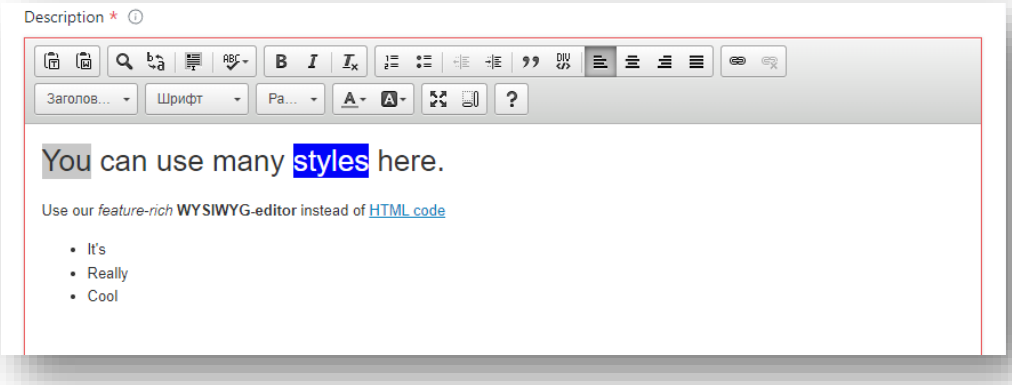
Logo



Use this section to upload a logo for your product.
ATTENTION: it's a product logo, not your vendor logo.
The Image should be 200x282px in JPEG or PNG format. You can upload an image by clicking **Select product image** or use "Drag-n-Drop". If your logo image does not meet the required dimensions, the system will notify you.

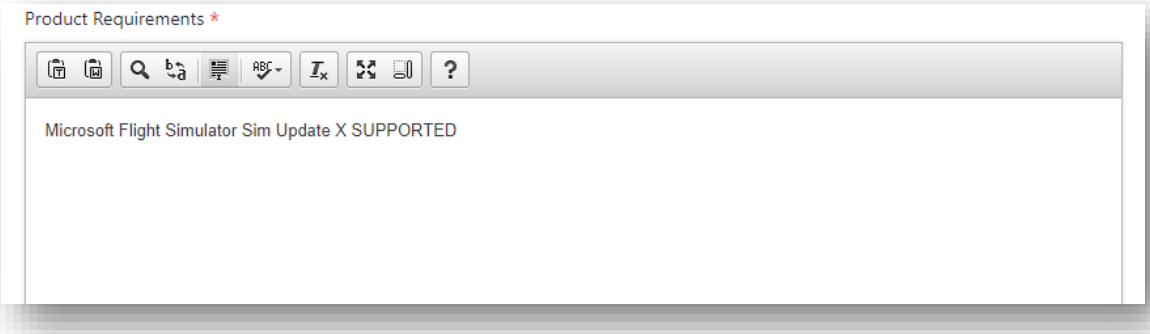
The product logo is an important element for sales and marketing, if creative it will attract more customers.

Description



Describe your product, tell the customer what it represents, what features it has and why they should purchase it. Possibly do not copy texts from Wikipedia, preferably write your own. If you like to add any text effects or formats (like lists) use our WYSIWYG-editor bar instead of copying HTML markup text. We do not recommend using the description field to add links to your support forum or Discord community as this will be added automatically to the products page from your account data entries but you can use WYSIWYG-editor to add link to product credits, for example the 3D-objects designer portfolio that you use in your scenery.

Product Requirements



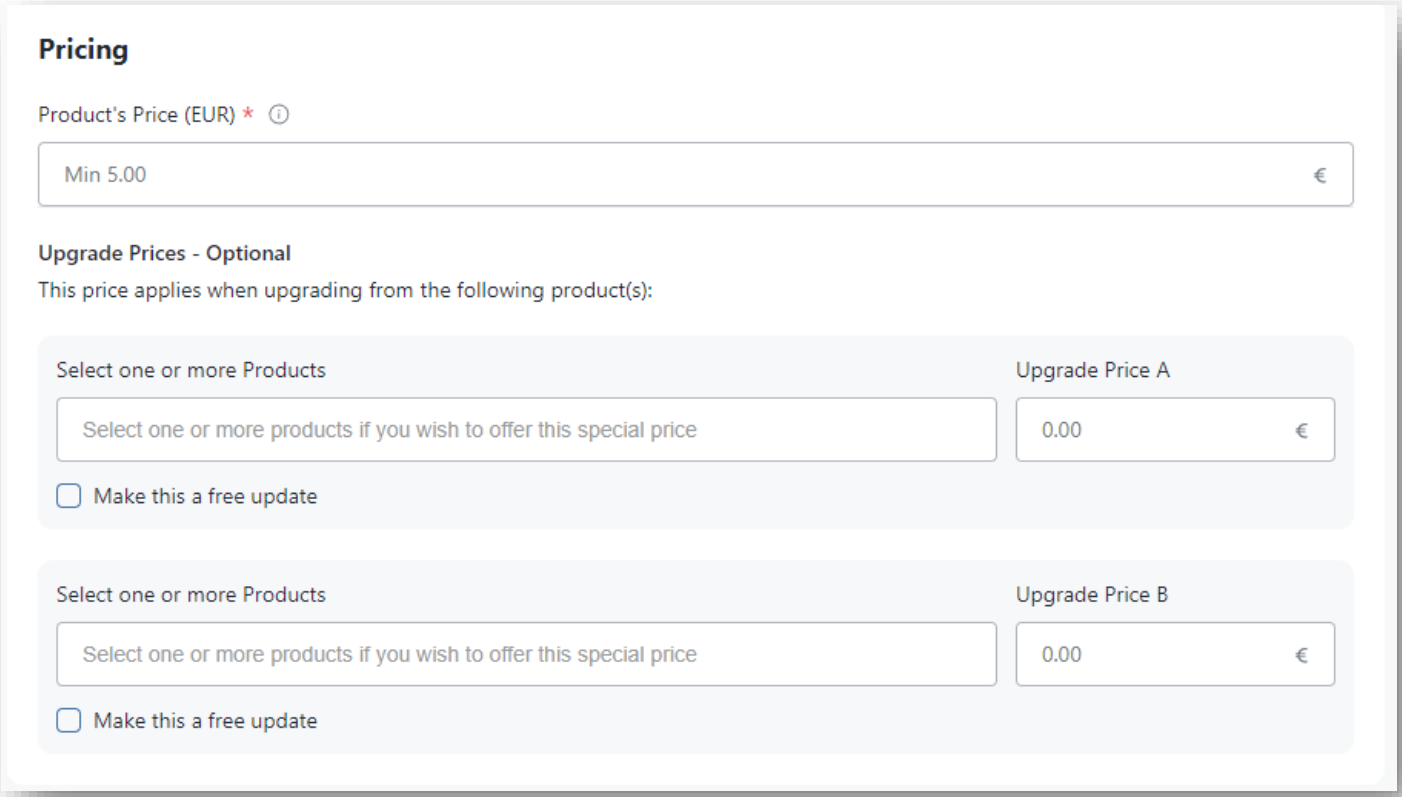
This text field is used for more detailed information about compatibility of your product and/or hardware requirements. Please double check this information and keep it updated after submitting product updates, it is very important for customers and avoids justified refund requests later.

For MSFS we recommend adding information about Sim Update and World Update compatibility.

Order Email Text

Optional field. you can use it to convey any message pertaining to the product to your customers The text in this field will be included in the customer order confirmation mail.

Step 2: Pricing



Product's Price (EUR)

Set the price for your product in EURO here. Keep in mind, the minimal price for payware products is 5 EURO and pricing is set net, e.g. WITHOUT VAT.

Upgrade Prices

Optional field, you can offer discounts for your existing customers. Here are short instructions on how it works:

To set discounts use the “Product Upgrade Path A” and if required also the “Product Upgrade Path B” areas.

You can use several scenarios to offer upgrade discounts. For example, if a customer already has the Prepar3D version of your product for Microsoft Flight Simulator, then you can offer a special price.

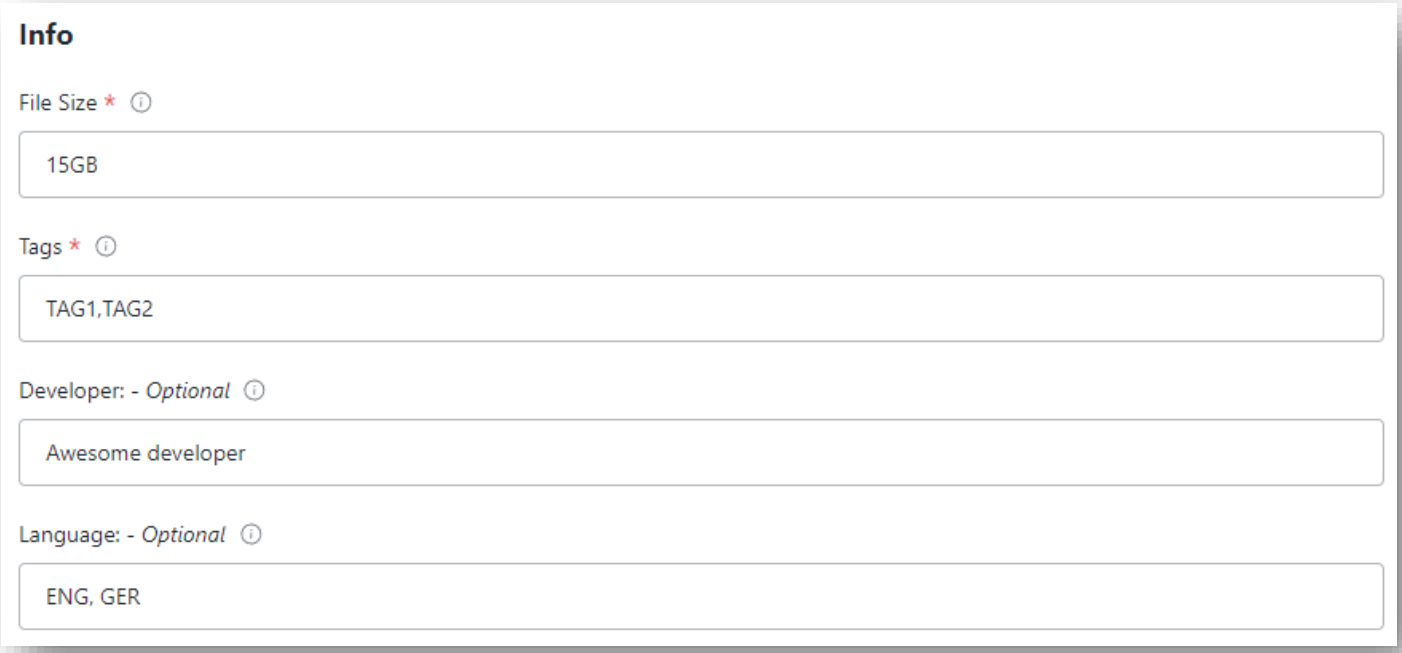
Product Upgrade Path A: Choose one or more previous products from the list offered and enter the upgrade price.

Product Upgrade Path B: Or maybe the customer owns an even older version of that product that is not on sale anymore? You could offer a different discount in that case. Select the product and set the price!

You can use several products for upgrade discount, you can combine upgrade plans to make your customers happy. Use it wisely, but remember, the minimum upgrade price is 5€!

Also you can offer a free update, to do this check the **Make this a free update** item.

STEP 3: INFO



File Size

Enter your total file size during download, not install size. You can enter information in MB or GB.

Tags

Enter a few tags for your products separated by comma. For example, ICAO and IATA code, the country and continent where the airport is located, etc.
Do not exaggerate, we do check this before release.

Developer

Optional field. If you are an addons publisher you can enter the individual developer name here.

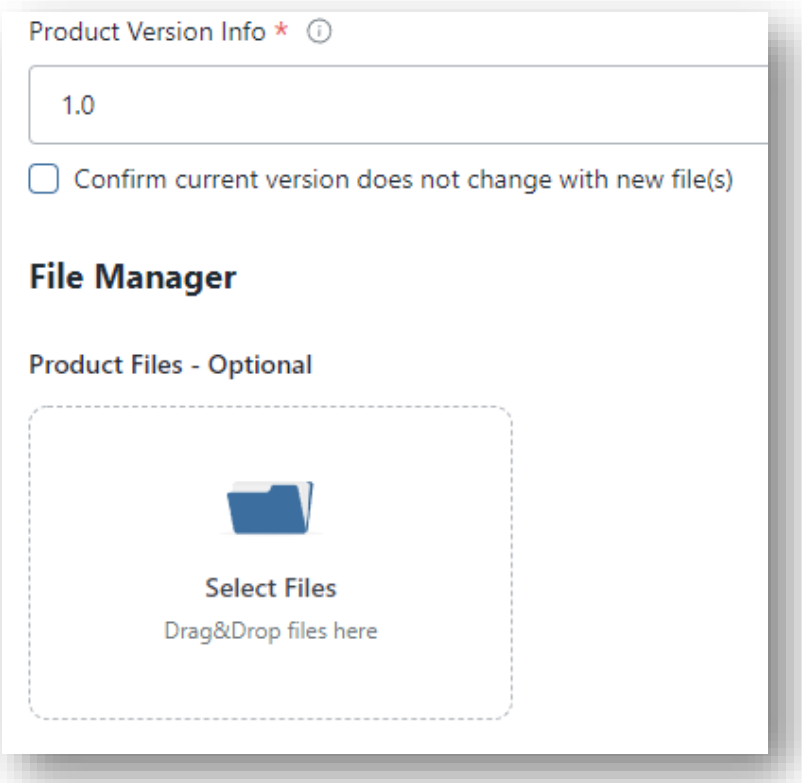
Language

Optional field. Fill it if you want to point in what languages you offer support, manuals etc.

Step 4: File Manager

Now you're ready to upload your product files.

Product Version Info



Fill the initial version of your product for a new product or a new version number for an update. You can use your internal version numbers. This is used to manage updates for customers, therefore it is quite important.

Now let's move to the **File Manager** section.

Product Files - Optional

Use **Select Files** or "Drag-n-Drop" to upload your product files. We accept ZIP files and EXE files for addons products and PDF and TXT files for manuals.

Important for MSFS products:

We may only use two ways to present MSFS products to customers:

1. Our simInstaller, where the only thing you have to do is to upload a zip file containing the product files structured according to the MSFS SDK, eg. in the correct folders and accompanied by correctly made manifest.json and a layout.json.

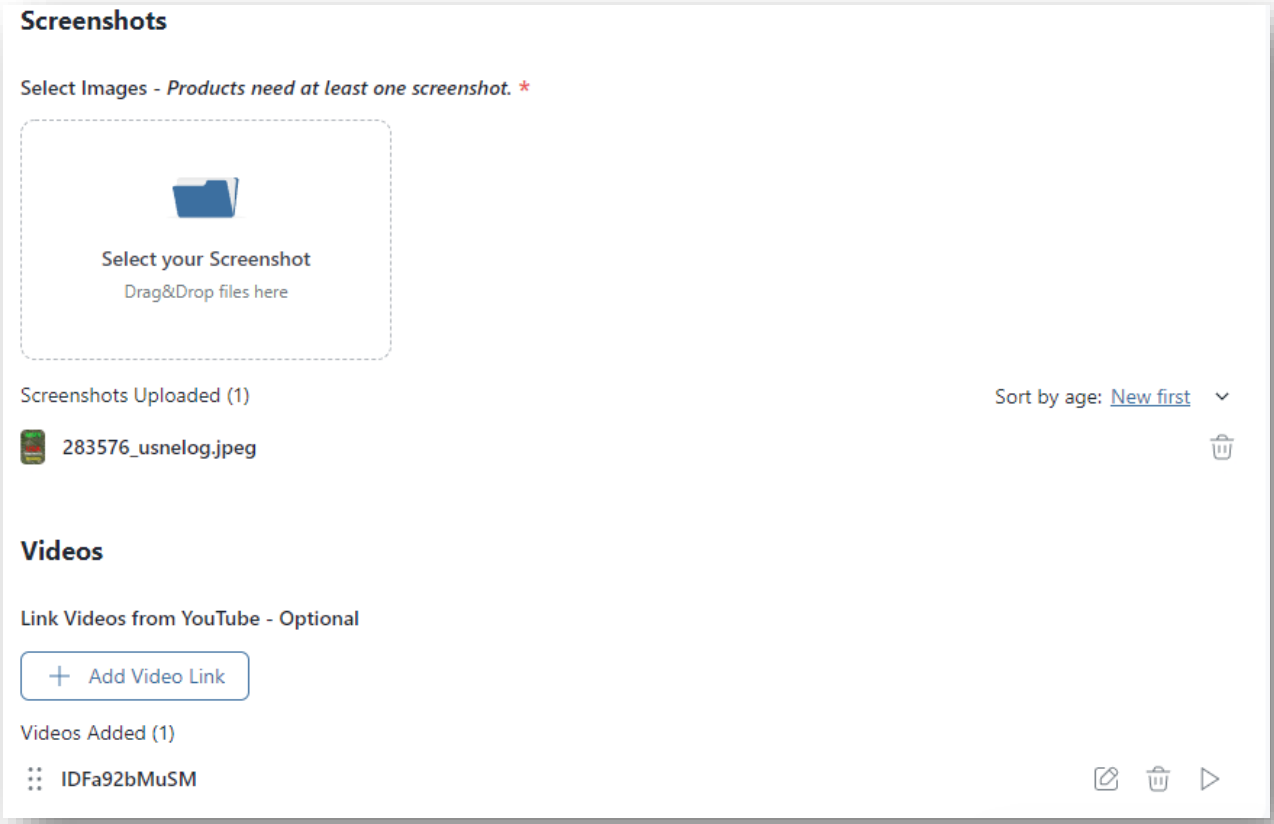
Our script will then accept the upload and your product will be correctly downloaded, extracted and installed into the customers MSFS via our app with one click of a button. Of course may upload eventual product manuals separate as pdfs or in txt format.

2. Your own installer, e.g a .exe or msi that you made that will install the product after being downloaded by the customer. Of course we strongly recommend using option 1 as this is the most comfortable for everyone.

You'll see a progress bar during the upload and you are able to pause the process, clear the queue for all files or for separate files.

Once upload completed you are able to use the **EDIT** button to set a different filename for the uploaded file.

Screenshots & Videos



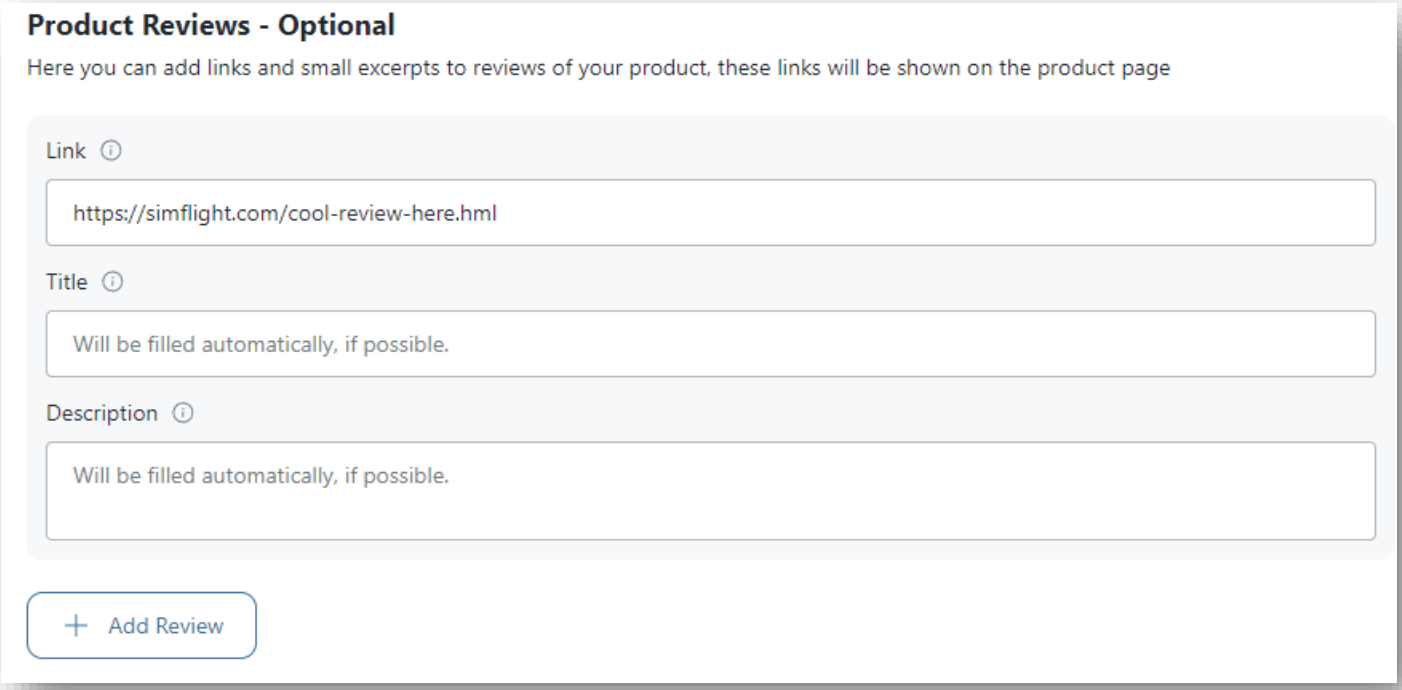
Use **Select your Screenshot** or "Drag-n-Drop" to upload screenshots. Be creative, show details and features!

Once your screenshots are uploaded you'll be able to sort them in the **Screenshots Uploaded** section, just use the mouse "Drag-n-Drop" for this.

If you have any promo-videos for your product (e.g trailer) use **+ ADD VIDEO LINK** button to add a link to the video. Currently we support only YouTube videos.

STEP 5: PRODUCT REVIEWS (OPTIONAL)

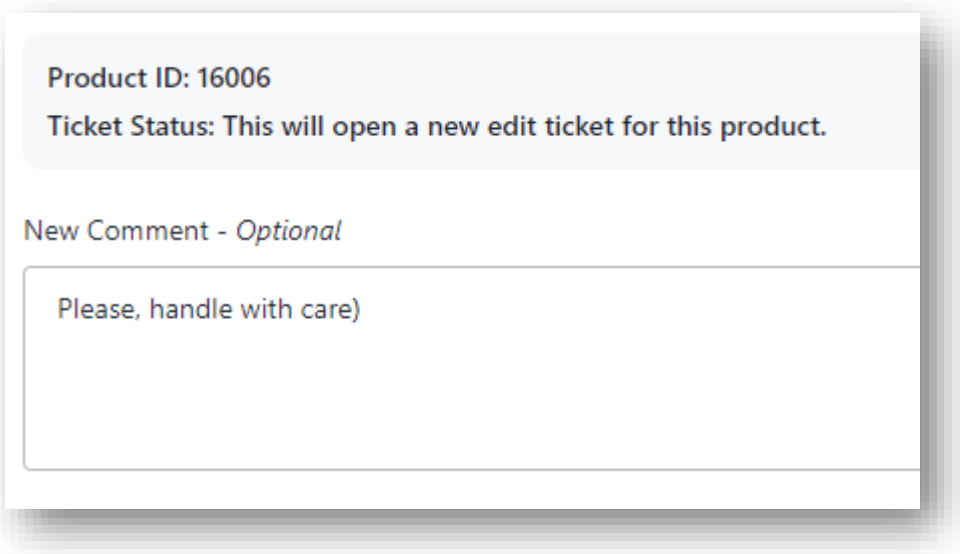
If you have any reviews for your products from third-party websites or bloggers use this tab to add information about it.



Just fill the **Link** field and if the website where the review is published is working fine our system will fetch the title and description automatically. If for some reason it does not work you are able to fill the **Title** and **Description** fields manually.

To add more reviews use the **+ ADD REVIEW** button.

Step 6: Instructions (Optional)



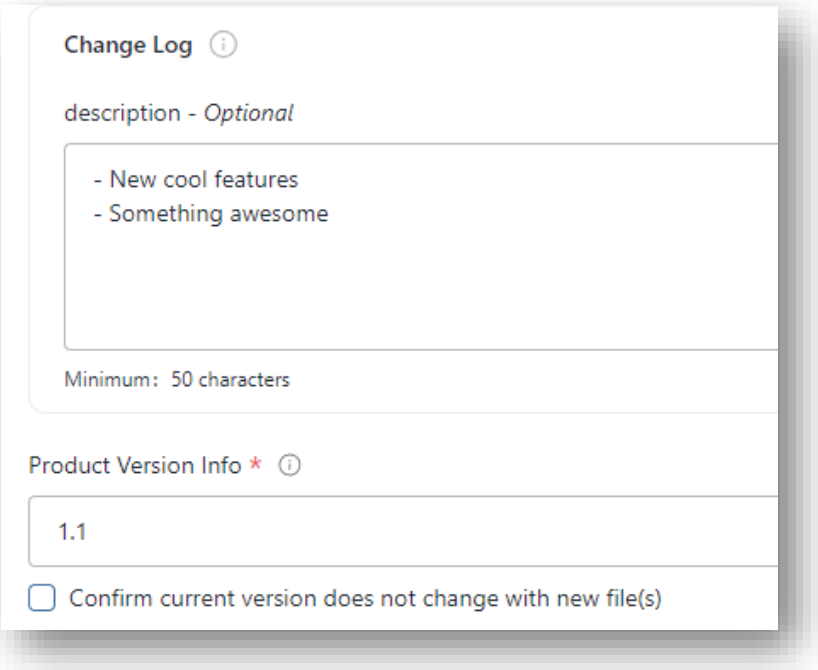
If you have any special instructions or comments for us, the SIMMARKET staff write it in the text field New Comment. For example, if you use your own secure installer and you need to add registration keys.

Now, when all is set you can proceed and press the **Continue** button to send your product for SIMMARKET team moderation.

EDIT EXISTING PRODUCT

To edit an existing product you have to select a product in the list and you'll see the same window as for new product. Let's talk about differences.

STEP 1: FILE MANAGER

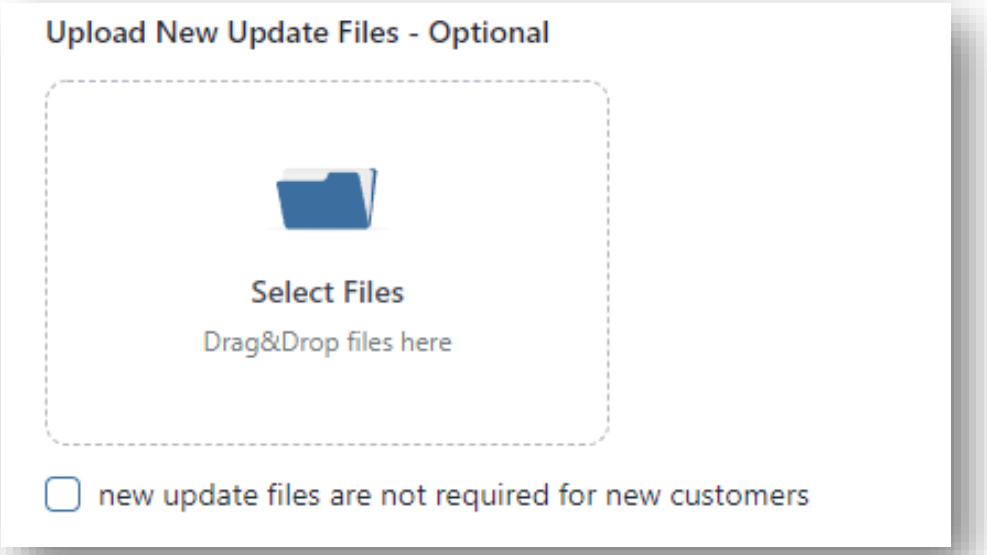


Change Log

If you are uploading an update you should always submit a written change-log for your customers to see what has changed.

Minimum 50 characters, maximum is 1500.

Files



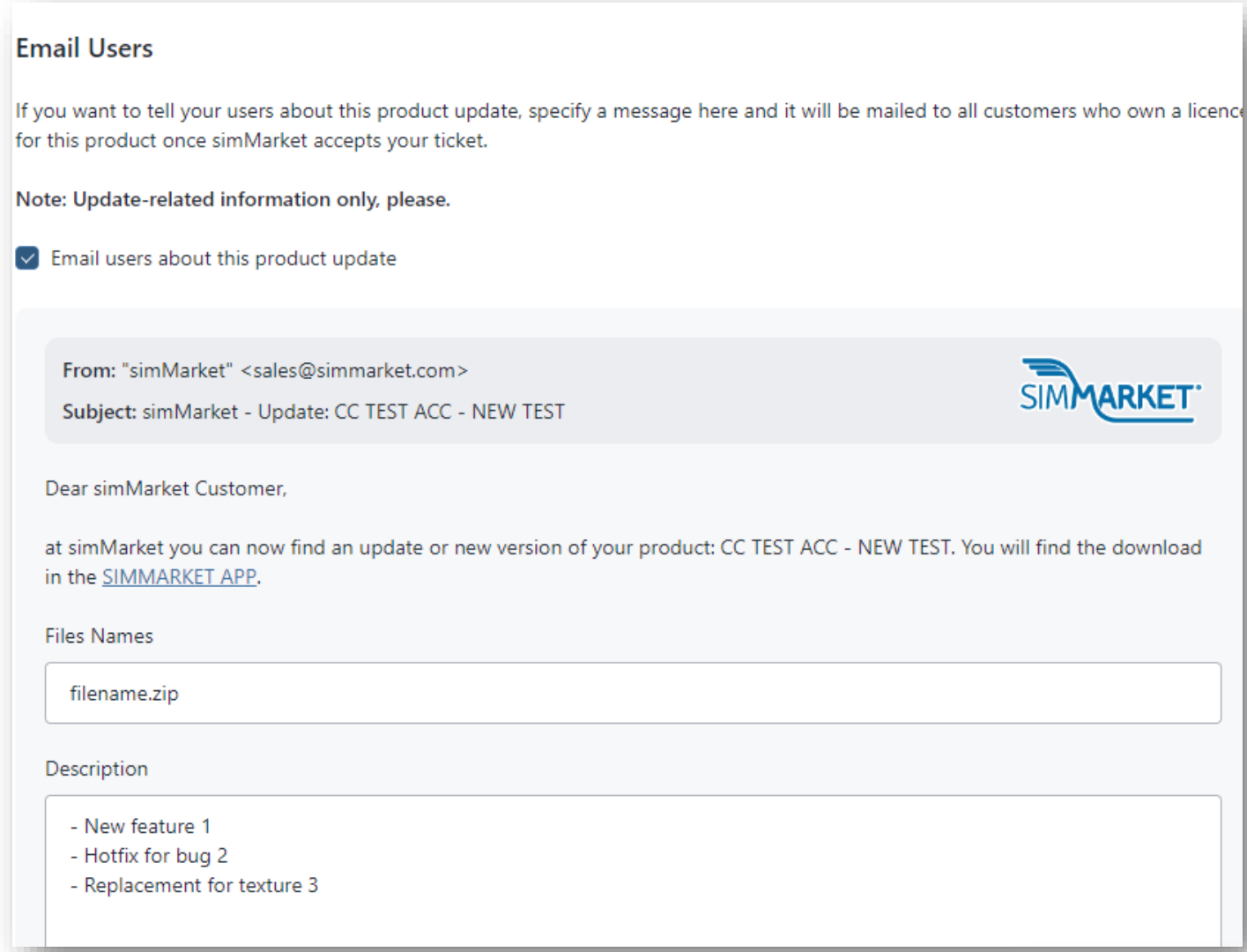
If you upload a full installer/product file then use **Product Files – Optional** section as you did when you submit the product for the first-time.

If you upload a hotfix or service pack, then use the **New Update Files – Optional** section. Here

you can also opt for the **new update files are not required for new customers** option if that is the case.

Step 2: Email Users (Optional)

If a mail is to be sent to your previous customers, for example containing a change-log, you can prepare and tick the **Email users about this product update** box.



Once everything is set go ahead and press **Continue** button to submit your product for SIMMARKET team moderation.

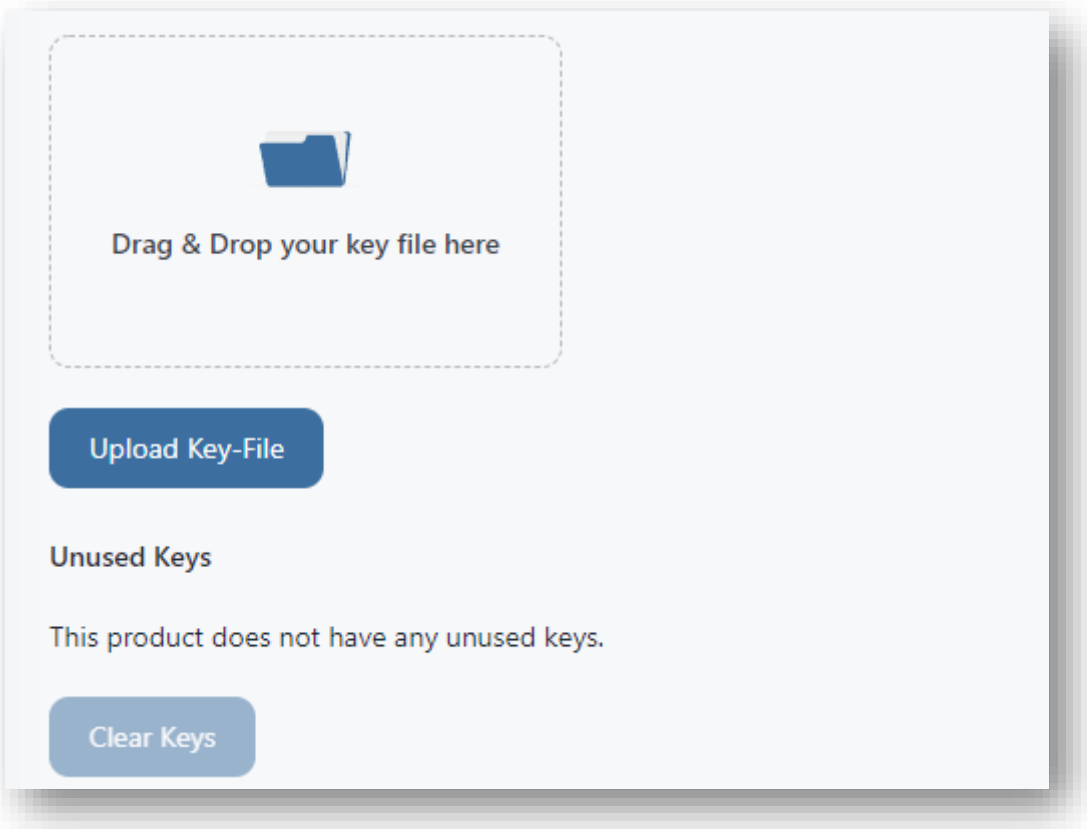
How to add keys for your product

Once you complete filling all product details, upload the file (s) and click on the **Continue** button. your product will be reviewed by our team. After this we will send a message back to you and you will be able to use the + Add Key button to upload the keys for your product.

Here is some important details about your file with registration keys:

- Each line must contain exactly one Key (no spaces or other character in it)
- Keys have to be between 6 and 80 characters long
- Keys must only contain alphanumeric characters, "-", "_", ":", ";", ",", "."
- The File must contain at least 100 keys
- The File must be a .txt

If your file is ready then click **Drag & Drop your key file here** or use "Drag-n-Drop" to upload. After the upload completes press **Upload Key-File** button.



PRODUCT TICKET STATUS

We have several statuses for your product tickets with different colors.

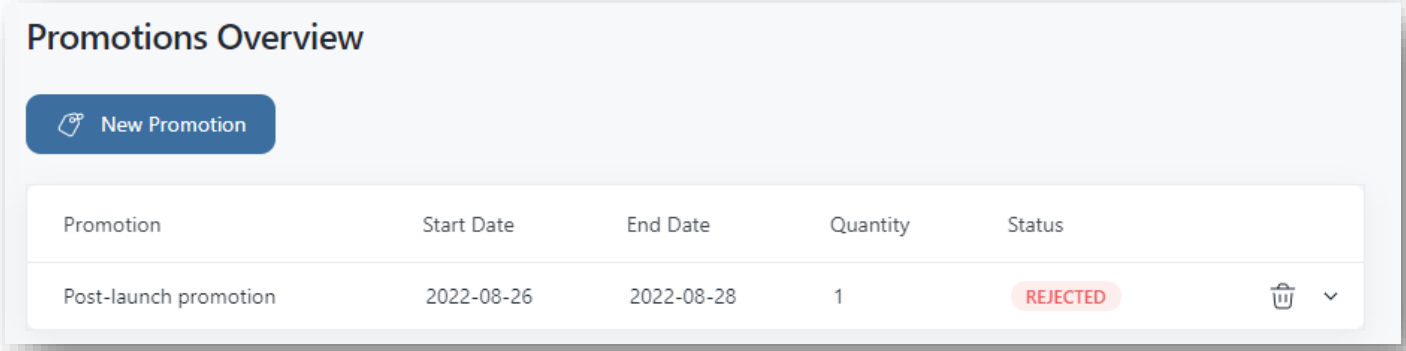
GREY – ticket is opened and awaiting processing by the SIMMARKET Team
BLUE – ticket is opened and the SIMMARKET Team is processing it
ORANGE – ticket is opened and awaiting YOUR reply
YELLOW – ticket is opened and waiting for YOUR revision

Promotions

You can control all your marketing activities with the Vendor Portal. In this section we will describe how to use it.

Promotions Overview

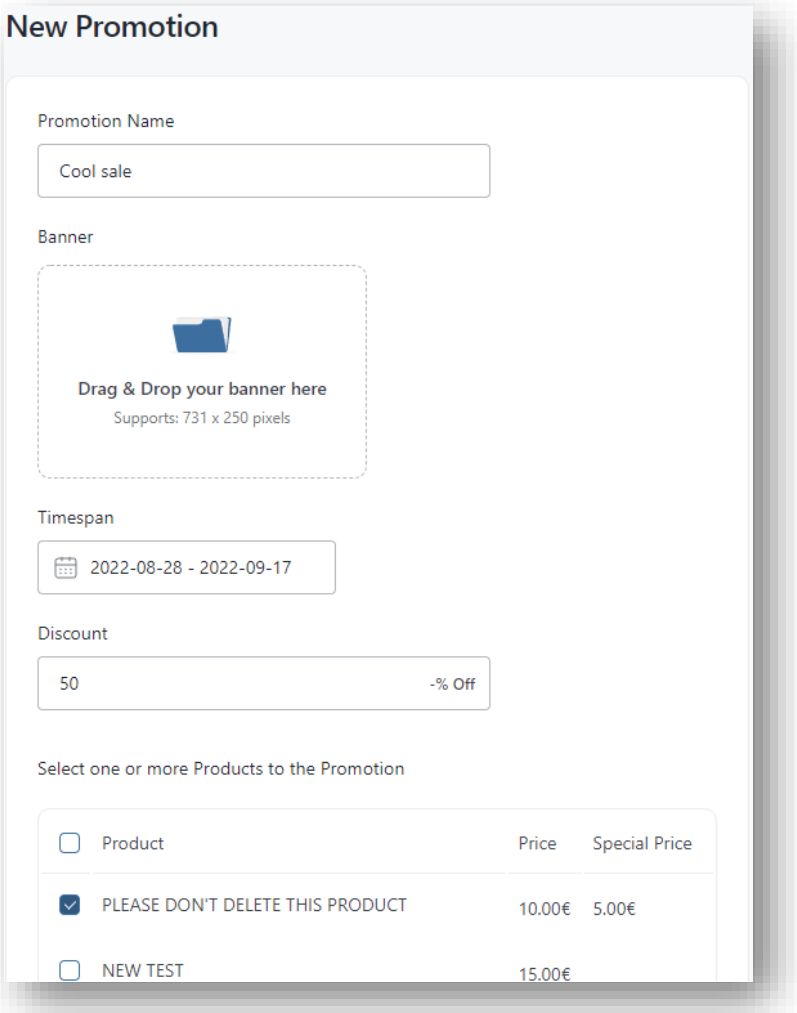
Here you can start your product promotions with the **New Promotion** button or list of all your current promos with approval status.



New Promotion

Here is some important rules about promos:

- A product's price can never be less than 5 Euro, even during special sales
- A special price should never be valid for more than 20 days in a row (exceptions can be made during the Black Friday, Christmas and New Years period)
- All Promotions are valid from 00:00:00 CET of the first day to 23:59:59 CET of the last day
- There will be a 10 day time-out period between sales for the same product
- A banner of 731x250px can promote the sale on the main page slider; the Vendor will upload the graphic for each promotion.



- Due to differing VAT rates in the EU, price reductions on banners can only be shown in percentage values (as in '30% off'), NEVER as an absolute price digit.
- All Promotions will be cleared by SIMMARKET before they go online.

Step 1: Promotion Name

Use the text field below to enter a title for your new promo. You can enter any name you like, it is only for internal use.

Step 2: Banner

Use this section to upload a banner for your promo. The banner size must be 731x250px. You can click Drag & Drop your banner here to select a file from your computer or use "Drag-n-Drop".

Step 3: Timespan

Set the time span of your promotion

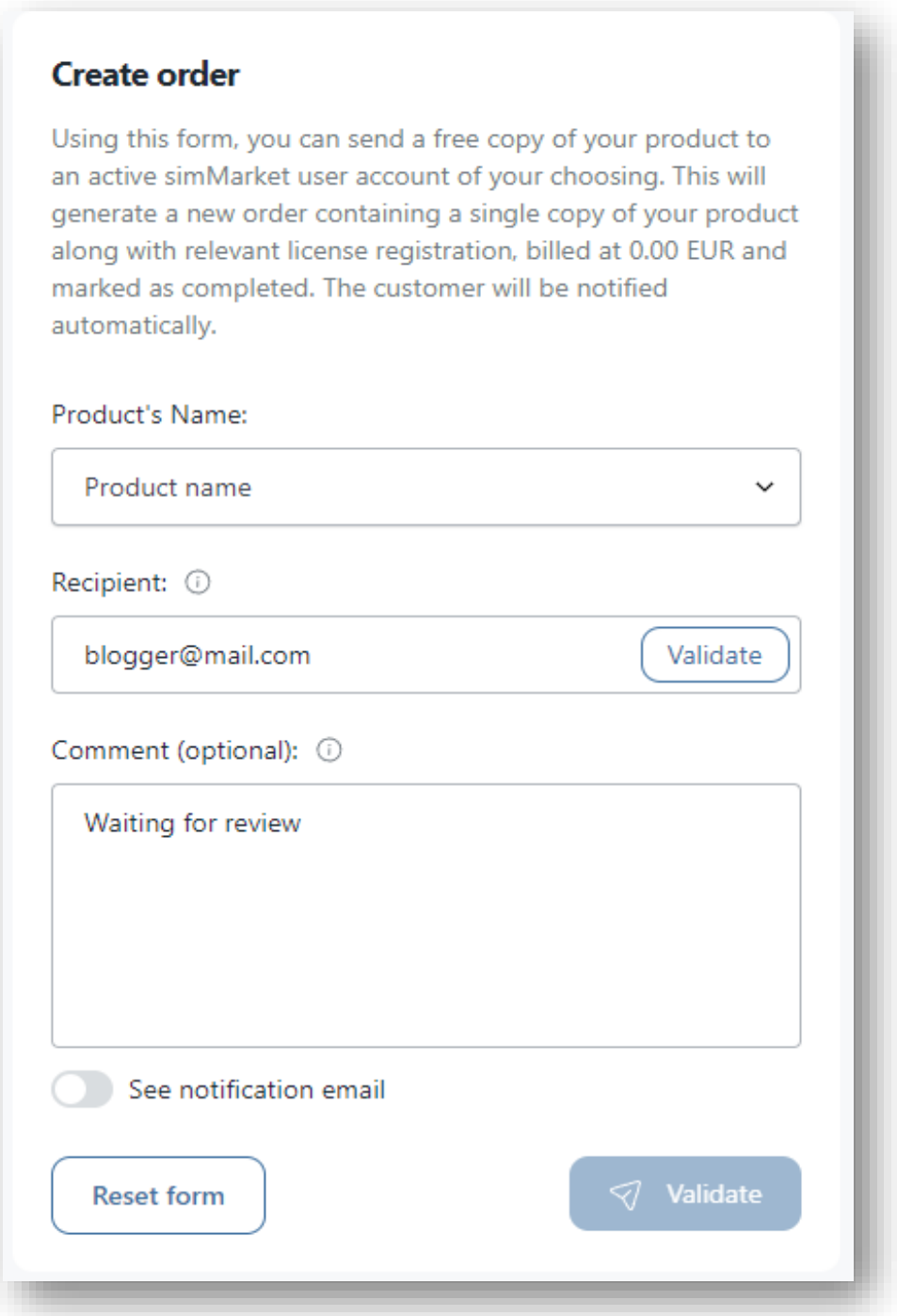
Step 4: Discount

Enter how much percent % **off** the regular price you want to set for your promo.

Step 5: Select one or more Products to the Promotion

In the list below you can see all your products, tick or untick products for create your promotion. The promotional price will be calculated automatically.

When you are ready and checked press the **Submit Promotion** button and your promo will be submitted for review by the SIMMARKET Team and if everything is correct, it will start on the date you set in step 3.



Here you can provide a press-copy of any of your products for review or as a giveaway to anyone of your choosing. Please note that the receiver **must have a registered account** on SIMMARKET:

This will generate a new order containing a single copy of your product along with any relevant license registration, billed at 0.00 EUR and marked as completed. The person will be notified automatically.

STEP 1: PRODUCT'S NAME

Select a product from the drop-down menu.

STEP 2: RECIPIENT

Enter the receiver's email or Customer ID and click on the **VALIDATE** button. If the receiver already has a registered account on SIMMARKET then validation is passed.

STEP 3: COMMENT (OPTIONAL)

You can fill in any text you like.

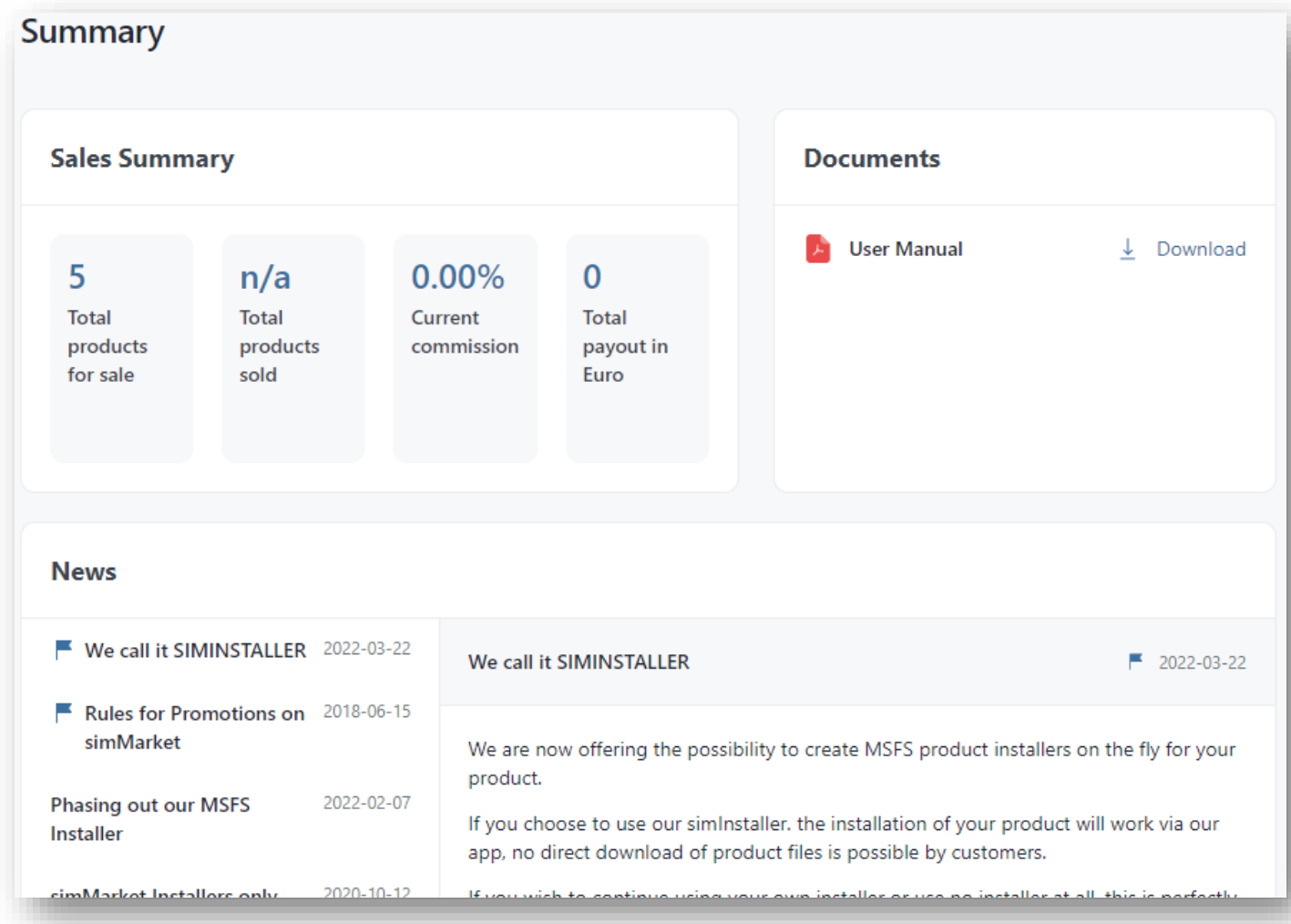
Step 4: Validation

Click on the **Validate** when you are ready and the order will be created and the receiver advised.

Account

Use this section to control your account and review reports.

Summary



Sales Summary

Basic information about your account is here. You can see how many products you have, total products sold, current commission and total payout in Euro.

Documents

In this section you'll find useful downloads for your account, like this manual.

News

News from the SIMMARKET Team about our store and recommendations for vendors.

Account Details

Your Details

When you first register into the Vendor Portal you have to prepare your vendor account and our system will open the "Account Details" page for you with a notification window "You need to provide support information before you can continue using the vendor portal". Let's do this!

The first form is "Your Details". Here you need to fill in all important details about your commercial name and your personal information.

Payment

The next stop is to select how you want to receive payouts from us. We have several options: Wise, SEPA, International Bank Transfer by SWIFT or PayPal. Just click on the drop-down menu "Payment method" to select one you like us to use.

Wise

You must have a Wise Account already, just enter your Wise account's email and set the target currency accordingly.

SEPA

If you are located in the SEPA or have a SEPA zone bank account then enter the needed data "Account holder/beneficiary", "IBAN" and "BIC".

International Bank Transfer (SWIFT)

For international payouts via SWIFT fill all your bank account details. To know all account details and rules you should contact your bank. Be aware that you as the beneficiary will carry all of the transfer costs.

PayPal

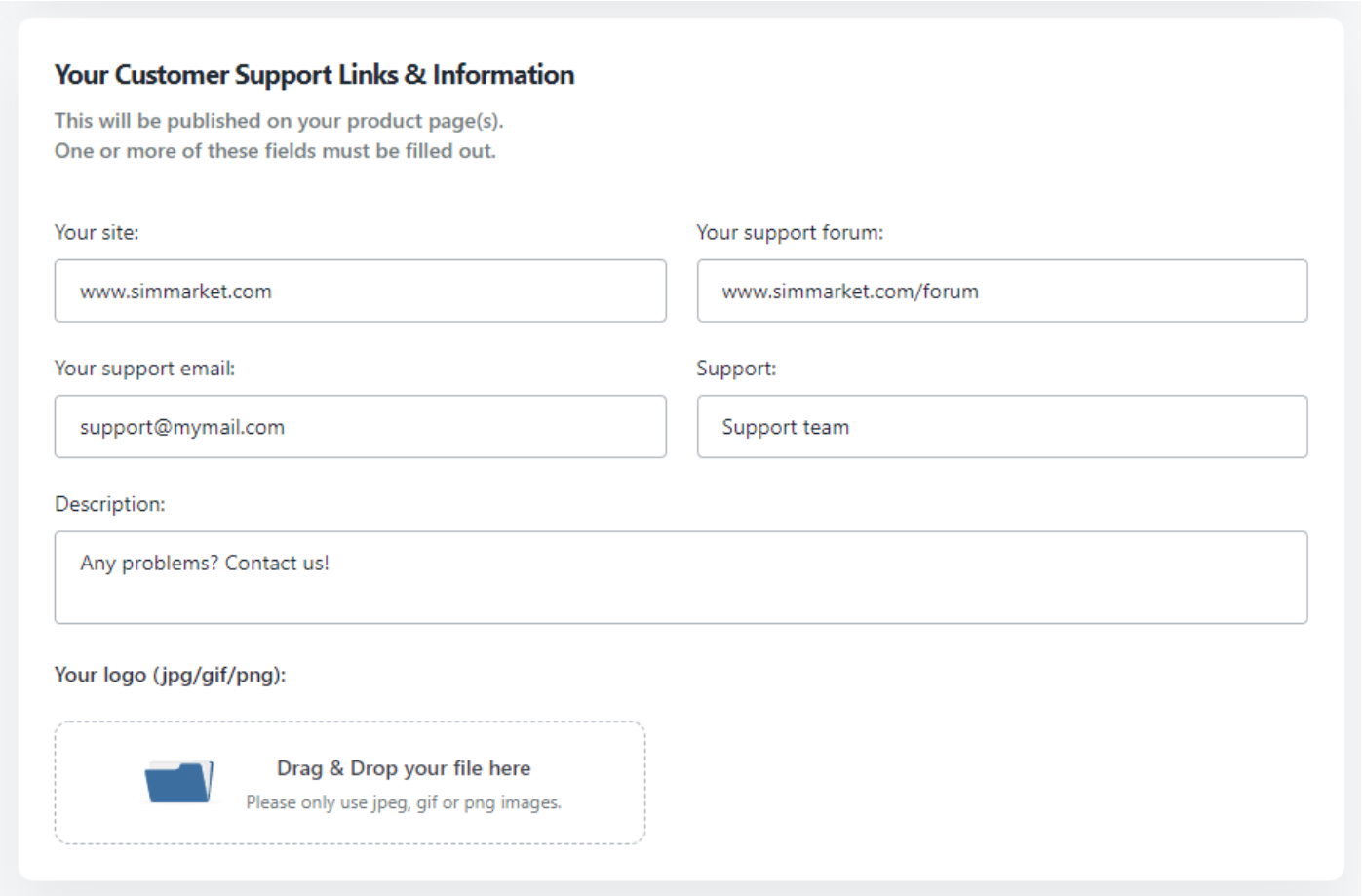
Enter your Paypal accounts email address.

Customer Support Links & Information

One of the most important parts of our business is customer care and support.

The SIMMARKET Team is the 1st line of support. We can resolve basic issues about your product, about the SIMMARKET APP, about sales and payments question.

Any questions related to technical issues specific to your product and features are of your responsibility. To help customers reach your support enter all fields in « Your Customer Support Links & Information» and add your logo. Information from this section will display in all your products pages and in your vendor page in the store and APP.



Once you entered all the required fields complete your setup by ticking the "I/We agree with the Conditions for the Sale of Products via SIMMARKET" box and click the **Continue** button.

Change Password

Use this form to change your Vendor Portal password.

All Sales

Information about your sales. You can build this report to show summary details or show information only about specified customers, registration key or orders. You can set a period for the report with a date selection form. If you like you can build a report for specified order status from the drop-down menu.

Sales Report

In this section you'll find your monthly sales reports with payment status. If you press the "paper clip" icon you will be able to download additional reports like a country report, the sales report and the Self-Billing Invoice.

Products Sold

Detailed information about products sold , you can select dates for more refined viewing.

Customer Support

Your customer support platform.

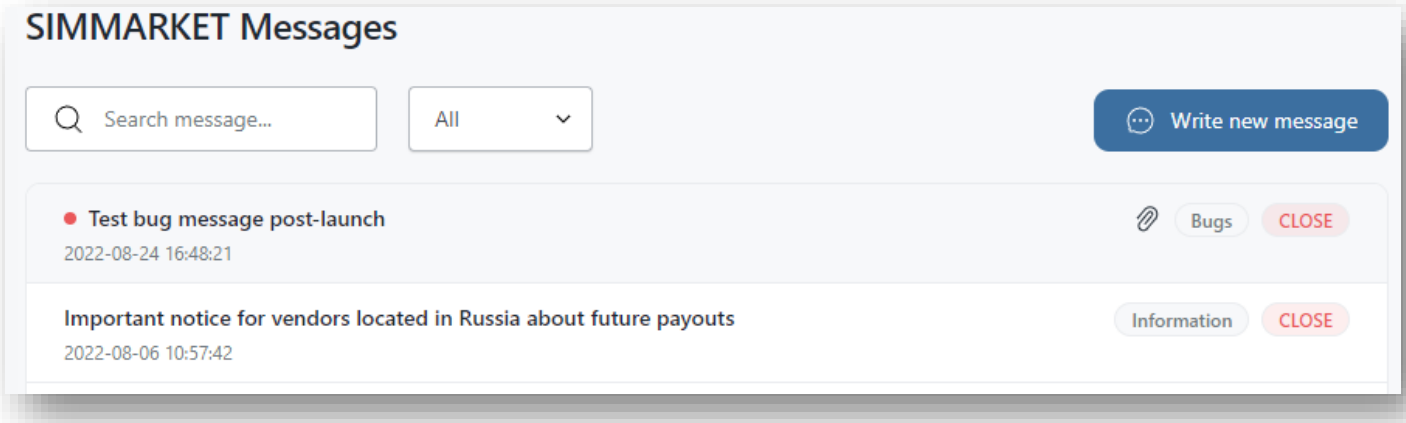
When the SIMMARKET Team is unable to resolve a customer issue we will forward their ticket to you and you will communicate directly with your customer from here

Filtering options are available.

Please, keep in mind that support is an important part of your success. If you ignore customer requests for support it’s bad for your business.

SIMMARKET MESSAGES

Direct contact with the SIMMARKET Team.
You can contact us here or reply to our messages.



To start a new conversation, use the **WRITE NEW MESSAGE** button.

If you are looking for particular message, use the search form.